



Google kills Google

Google France shuts down its own page on Google+, Google's own social network. <https://dgit.in/sep18-45-1>



AT&T, T-Mobile, and Sprint flaw

Researchers have uncovered flaws with systems at AT&T, Sprint, and T-Mobile that could've left customer data vulnerable. <https://dgit.in/sep18-45-2>

tech

HEAD-ON

WEIGHT

HERO LECTRO EZEPHYR

The advantage of using aluminium for the frame is a light-weight design. However, not as light as titanium or carbon. The EZephyr weighs at 16 kg which is a little too much. Before you call out names to the bike, don't forget there's a frigging battery sitting inside. The weight can be a problem when you have to lug the bike up the stairs in an apartment though. Guess this is the bike making sure you burn some fat even though it has a battery.

TREK ÉMONDA ALR 5

This one also uses an aluminium frame, so naturally it's light-weight. Add to that the carbon fork and steerer, the bike manages to discard some more weight. Traditionally, road bikes are lightweight and the Émonda ALR 5 weighs only 8.47 kg. This is almost half of the EZephyr's weight. Carrying this baby up the stairs in apartment complexes is so easy, that we started doing it just to show off, at times right in front of the deprecating stares of the lift man.

GEARING

HERO LECTRO EZEPHYR

The gearing in a bike consists of several components including the shifters, front and rear derailleurs, crank, cassette or free-wheel, and chain. Hero isn't open about all of them and only mentions the ones from top bike component manufacturer Shimano. The EZephyr uses Shimano components on the shifters (7-speed), rear derailleurs and freewheel.

TREK ÉMONDA ALR 5

Being a premium bike, all the parts are made of top quality so the entire gearing or drivetrain on the Émonda ALR 5 consists of parts from Shimano including an 11 speed shifter. There is a cassette system on the ALR 5. The only real difference this makes is that you cannot backpedal. This is necessary as the freewheel cannot be made for more than 7 gears.

BRAKES

HERO LECTRO EZEPHYR

For a bike that is meant to be used for commute and casual riding, the rear V-brake and front disc brake are enough. In the electric mode, you won't be going faster than 25 km/hr and the two brakes should be enough to make you come to a halt easily.

TREK ÉMONDA ALR 5

While riding road bikes, you will be zooming on the roads considering the high speeds you can attain on these. Hence, the front and rear uses caliper brakes. Although hydraulic brakes are present on top end road bikes, the Émonda ALR 5 does not have these.

RIDING EXPERIENCE

HERO LECTRO EZEPHYR

This would be a more real-world take on the comparison. The electric pedal assistive technology on the EZephyr took away the effort from our legs and made us less fatigued for the same distance travelled on the Émonda ALR 5. We could also not pedal at all and just zoom across the street using the accelerator. It automatically becomes a great choice for commuting everyday. The only problem would be looking for a charging port when it runs out.

TREK ÉMONDA ALR 5

Covering long distances at high speeds is what the Émonda ALR 5 is made for. It did take us some time to get used to the non-conventional stance of bending over and pedaling since we aren't really used to it. However, after a few hours, we would naturally curve our backs and pedal along on this bike. This bike was a pleasure to ride, even when going uphill. Both of the bikes do not have suspension, so it's not favourable to ride on roads riddled by potholes.

CONCLUSION

During the course of the head on, we tried to make the cycles compete against each other in various ways. One of the considerations was to find some common ground between the electric cycle and the road bike, so that they could compete on equal terms. We had to throw out

that consideration after looking at how different the two really were. It was as much as the people riding it as the bikes themselves. We found out that there is time tested tradition of people and their bikes being pitted against each other. This is the sport of bicycle jousting. The lances

are made up of PVC pipes, and we had some of those lying around. We knew this was terribly unsafe, and was bound to end up in some cuts and bruises considering the minimal amount of safety equipment we had (just one helmet). Well, we were right about the cuts and bruises. **d**